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Recruitment Rules relating to various cadres in D/o Posts

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

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Chapter 1: Introduction & Constitutional Basis

1.1 What are Recruitment Rules?

Recruitment Rules (RRs) are statutory rules framed under the proviso to Article 309 of the Constitution of India. They regulate the method of recruitment and conditions of service for various posts under the Central Government. In the Department of Posts (DoP), separate RRs are notified through Gazette of India notifications for each cadre.

Every Recruitment Rule notification follows a standard 13-point Schedule format prescribed by the Department of Personnel & Training (DoPT), covering essential parameters from the name of the post to the composition of the Departmental Promotion Committee (DPC).

1.2 Constitutional Foundation

Article 309 (Proviso): Acts of the appropriate Legislature may regulate the recruitment, and conditions of service of persons appointed, to public services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union or of any State. Provided that it shall be competent for the President or such person as he may direct, in the case of services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union, to make rules regulating the recruitment and the conditions of service.

★ **NOTE:** Article 309 proviso is the enabling provision for ALL recruitment rules. The President makes RRs, published via Gazette Notification (G.S.R. number).

1.3 The Standard 13-Point Schedule Format

Every RR notification in DoP follows this uniform schedule prescribed by DoPT:

Col. No.	Parameter
1	Name of the Post
2	Number of Posts (with * subject to variation on workload)
3	Classification (GCS, Group, Gazetted/Non-Gazetted, Ministerial/Non-Ministerial)
4	Pay Level in the Pay Matrix (7th CPC)
5	Whether Selection Post or Non-Selection Post
6	Age Limit for Direct Recruits

Col. No.	Parameter
7	Educational & Other Qualifications for Direct Recruits
8	Whether age & educational qualifications for DR apply to Promotees
9	Period of Probation, if any
10	Method of Recruitment (DR / Promotion / Deputation / LDCE) with Percentages
11	In case of Promotion/Deputation – Feeder Grade & Qualifying Service
12	Composition of DPC
13	Circumstances in which UPSC to be consulted

1.4 Key Amendments Tracker

Multiple RRs in DoP have been amended over the years. The most significant wave of amendments came in 2017, when the 7th CPC pay matrix levels were substituted in all existing RRs through a series of G.S.R. notifications (649(E) to 655(E), all dated 28.06.2017). The PA/SA RR 2022 and its subsequent amendments in 2023 and 2024 are also crucial.

Chapter 2: Common Provisions Across All Recruitment Rules

All RR notifications in the Department of Posts contain certain standard rules that are common across cadres. Understanding these ensures you do not waste time re-reading repetitive language in each notification.

2.1 Disqualification (Bigamy Clause)

Every RR contains a standard disqualification clause: No person who has entered into or contracted a marriage with a person having a spouse living, or who, having a spouse living, has entered into or contracted a marriage with any person, shall be eligible for appointment. However, the Central Government may exempt a person if such marriage is permissible under the personal law applicable to them.

★ **NOTE:** *This is a verbatim common clause across ALL cadre RRs. If asked 'Which clause is common to all RRs?' – Disqualification (Bigamy) is the answer.*

2.2 Power to Relax

Where the Central Government is of the opinion that it is necessary or expedient so to do, it may, by order, for reasons to be recorded in writing, and in consultation with the UPSC (where applicable), relax any of the provisions of the rules with respect to any class or category of persons.

2.3 Saving Clause (Reservation)

Nothing in the rules shall affect reservations, relaxation of age-limit and other concessions required to be provided for the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Ex-Servicemen, Other Backward Classes and other special categories of persons in accordance with the orders issued by the Central Government from time to time.

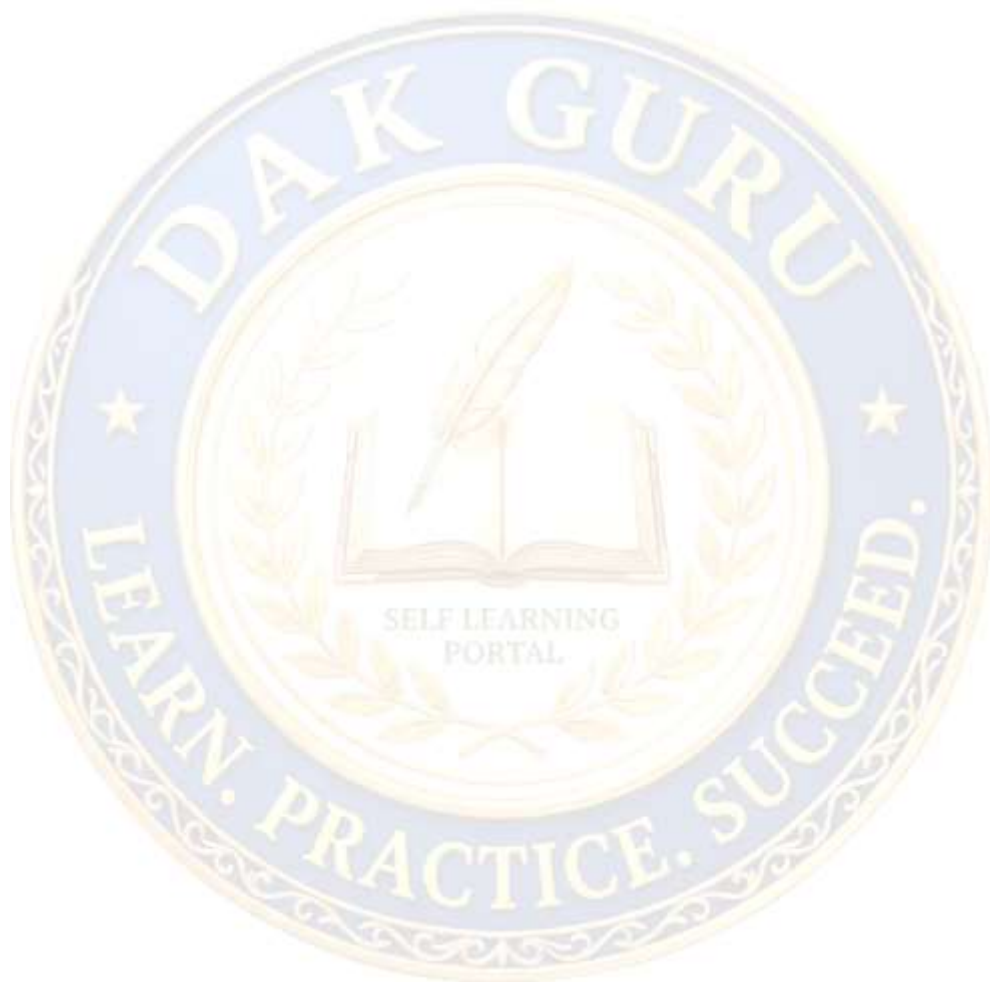
2.4 Liability for Service

Many cadre RRs (PA/SA, Postman, MTS) specifically include a clause that: Any person appointed to the post shall be liable to serve anywhere in India including in Army Postal Services. This is particularly notable for PA/SA and Postman cadres.

2.5 Standard Note on Juniors-Seniors (DPC Consideration)

Almost all RRs with promotion provisions carry this standard note: Where juniors who have completed their qualifying/eligibility service are being considered for promotion, their seniors would also be considered provided they are not short of the requisite qualifying/eligibility service by more than half of such qualifying/eligibility service or 2 years, whichever is less, and have successfully completed their probation period for

promotion to the next higher grade along with their juniors who have already completed such qualifying/eligibility service.



Chapter 3: Multi Tasking Staff (MTS) – Group C

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 781(E) dated 16.08.2018

Short Title: Department of Posts (Multi Tasking Staff) Recruitment Rules, 2018

Superseded: MTS Recruitment Rules, 2015

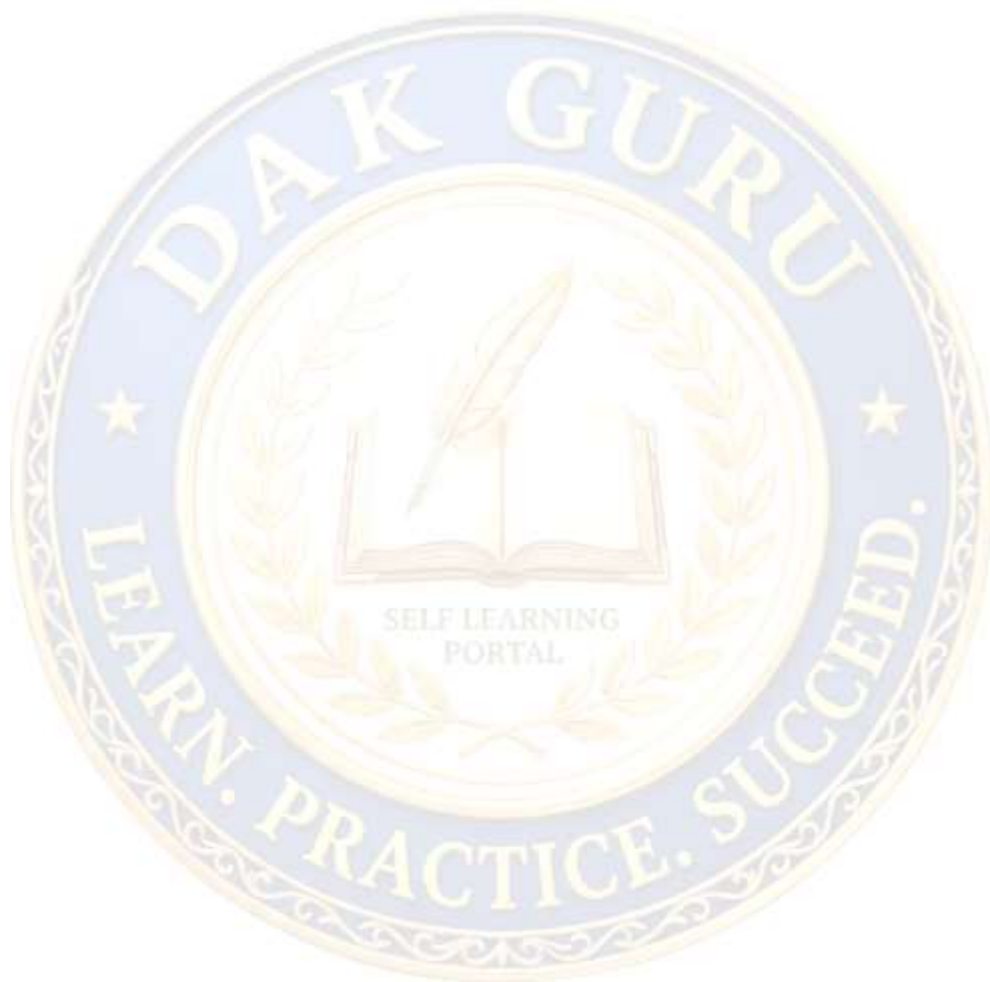
AMENDED G.S.R. 639(E) – Amendment Rules (7th CPC pay matrix update)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 1 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 18,000 – 56,900)
Selection/Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Age Limit (DR)	Between 18 and 25 years (Relaxable: SC/ST +5 yrs, OBC +3 yrs, Govt. Servants up to 35 yrs)
Educational Qualification (DR)	(i) 10th Standard pass from recognized Board (ii) Knowledge of local language (studied up to 10th) (iii) No educational qualification for Casual Labourers
Probation	Two years + successful completion of mandatory training
Method of Recruitment	(i) By appointment of Casual Labourers with temporary status (seniority-cum-fitness), failing which; (ii) By Direct Recruitment (100%) Note: DR through SSC or Employment Exchange
APS Liability	Liable to serve in Army Postal Service in India or abroad

Key Points for Exam:

- MTS is the lowest rung in the regular cadre hierarchy of DoP.

- No educational qualification is prescribed for Casual Labourers recruited as MTS.
- GDS and Casual Labourers have NO upper age limit for MTS recruitment.
- The RR has separate parts: Part-I (Administrative Offices), Part-II (Post Offices), Part-III (RMS Offices), Part-IV (SB Control Organisation), Part-V (IPSD).
- MTS is a Non-Ministerial post (not handling files/correspondence directly).



Chapter 4: Postman & Mail Guard – Group C

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 899(E) dated 20.09.2018

Short Title: Department of Posts Postman and Mail Guard (Group C post) Recruitment Rules, 2018

Superseded: Postman and Mail Guard RR, 2010

AMENDED G.S.R. 638(E) – Second Amendment (updated qualifying service, GDS age relaxation, etc.)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 3 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 21,700 – 69,100)
Selection/Non-Selection	Non-Selection
Age Limit (DR)	18–27 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3) GDS: 50 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3)
Educational Qualification (DR)	(i) 12th standard pass (ii) Knowledge of local language (studied up to 10th) (iii) Knowledge of working on Computer (iv) Valid 2-wheeler or LMV licence (PwD exempt)
Probation	Two years + successful completion of mandatory training
Method of Recruitment	(i) 25% by Promotion (Seniority-cum-fitness) from MTS (ii) 25% by Promotion from MTS through LDCE (iii) 50% by Direct Recruitment through competitive exam
Qualifying Service (Promotion)	MTS with 6 yrs regular service (for SCF) MTS with 3 yrs regular service (for LDCE)
APS Liability	Liable to serve in Army Postal Service

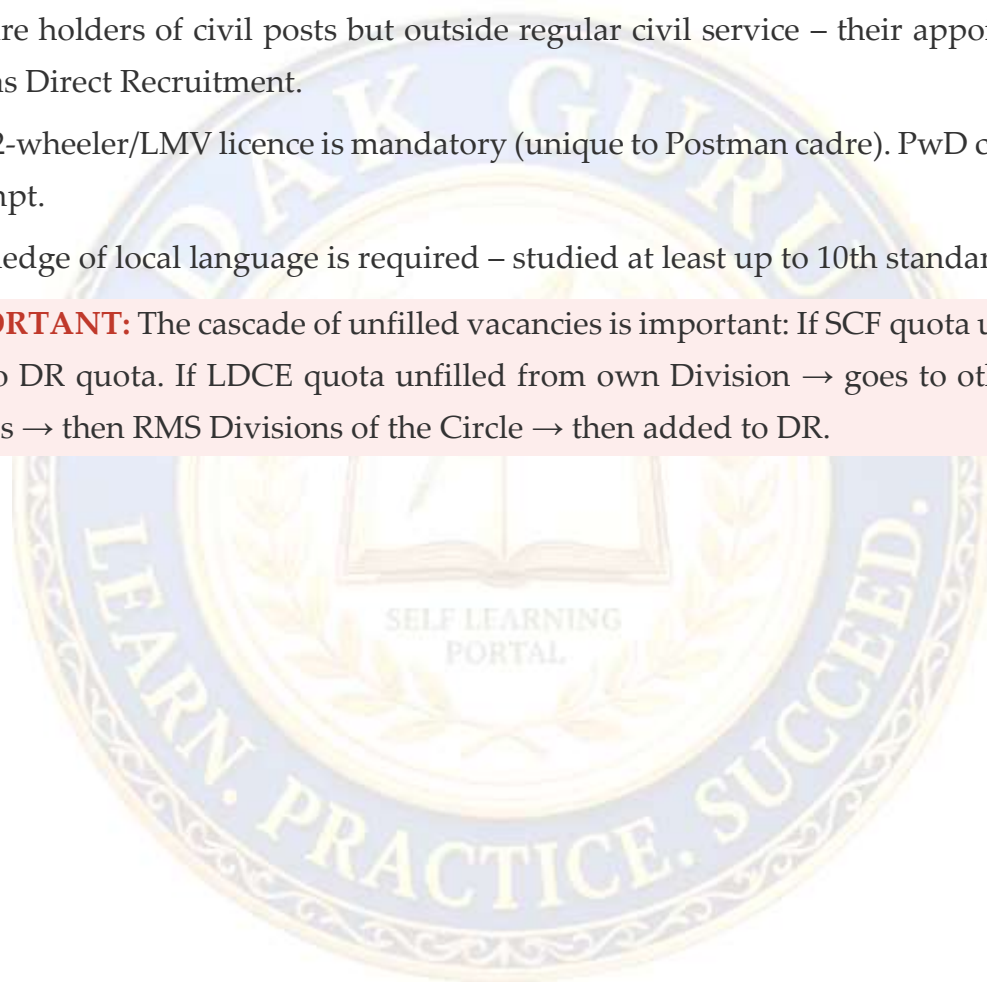
DPC Composition:

Departmental Promotion Committee (for promotion/confirmation): Composition as prescribed by the Circle Head. Consultation with UPSC is NOT necessary.

Key Points for Exam:

- Postman is a NON-MINISTERIAL post (delivery/outdoor work).
- The 25% SCF + 25% LDCE + 50% DR ratio is very important for MCQs.
- GDS are holders of civil posts but outside regular civil service – their appointment is treated as Direct Recruitment.
- Valid 2-wheeler/LMV licence is mandatory (unique to Postman cadre). PwD candidates are exempt.
- Knowledge of local language is required – studied at least up to 10th standard.

△ IMPORTANT: The cascade of unfilled vacancies is important: If SCF quota unfilled → added to DR quota. If LDCE quota unfilled from own Division → goes to other Postal Divisions → then RMS Divisions of the Circle → then added to DR.



Chapter 5: Postal Assistant & Sorting Assistant – Group C

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 459(E) dated 17.06.2022

Short Title: Department of Posts (Postal Assistant & Sorting Assistant) Recruitment Rules, 2022

Superseded: PA & SA Group C (Non-Gazetted) RR, 2015

AMENDED G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023 – First Amendment (title change, qualifying service clarification)

AMENDED G.S.R. 470(E) – Second Amendment (updated method of recruitment percentages)

5.1 Sub-Cadres Under PA/SA RR 2022:

The RR covers FIVE distinct sub-cadres under one notification:

1. PA (Circle Office and Regional Offices)
2. PA (Foreign Post Organisations in Chennai, Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai)
3. PA (Savings Bank Control and Internal Check Organisations)
4. PA (Post Office)
5. Sorting Assistant (Railway Mail Service)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 4 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 25,500 – 81,100)
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post
Age Limit (DR)	18–27 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3, Govt. Servants as per rules) GDS: 40 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3)

Parameter	Details
Educational Qualification (DR)	(i) Bachelor's Degree from recognized University or Institute (ii) Knowledge of working on Computer Note: 10+2 continues for GDS on regular basis on date of notification
Probation	Two years for Direct Recruits (with successful completion of Induction Training)
Method of Recruitment	(i) 40% by Promotion through LDCE (from Part-A feeder grades) Failing which: from Part-B feeder grades through LDCE Failing which: by DR (ii) 60% by Direct Recruitment through competitive examination

5.2 Feeder Grades for Promotion through LDCE:

Part (A) – Primary Feeder:

Officials in Level 3 with 3 years regular service OR 5 years combined service in Level 1, 2, and 3. This includes Postman, Mail Guard, MTS promoted to Postman level, etc.

Part (B) – Secondary Feeder:

Officials in Level 1 or Level 2 with five years of regular service. This covers MTS who have completed 5 years but are not yet in Level 3.

★ **NOTE:** PA/SA is the FIRST Ministerial post in the postal hierarchy. It is the gateway cadre for further promotions to LSG → HSG-II → HSG-I → IP → ASP → PS Gr.B → IPoS. This is the single most important RR for LDCE IP candidates to know thoroughly.

△ **IMPORTANT:** GDS are holders of civil posts but outside regular civil service. Their appointment as PA/SA is treated as Direct Recruitment. The educational qualification for GDS candidates is relaxed to 10+2 (instead of Graduation) for those holding GDS posts on regular basis on the date of notification.

Chapter 6: Stenographer Grade II – Group C

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. notified in 2014

Short Title: Department of Posts (Stenographer Grade II) Recruitment Rules, 2014

Superseded: Stenographer Grade 'D' RR, 1986

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 4 in the Pay Matrix (formerly PB-1 Rs. 5200–20200 + GP 2400)
Selection/Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Age Limit (DR)	18–27 years (Govt. Servants up to 40; SC/ST up to 45)
Method of Recruitment	By Direct Recruitment through SSC
Promotion Pathway	Steno Gr-II → Steno Gr-I (Level 6) → Eligible for LDCE IP

★ **NOTE:** Stenographer Grade-I (Level 6) and Stenographer Grade-II (Level 4) are both eligible feeder grades for LDCE IP examination with 8 years qualifying service.

Chapter 7: Lower Selection Grade (LSG) – Group C (Non-Gazetted)

Original Notification: G.S.R. 62(E) dated 31.01.2011 (LSG Posts RR, 2011)

Amendment: G.S.R. 649(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC Pay Matrix substitution)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 5 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 29,200 – 92,300)
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Postal Assistants / Sorting Assistants in Level 4
Qualifying Service	Five years of regular service in the feeder grade (Level 4)
Training Requirement	Successful completion of two weeks Departmental Training
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post

Sub-Categories of LSG Posts:

The LSG RR covers 9 sub-categories: (1) LSG in Post Offices, (2) LSG in RMS Offices, (3) LSG in Returned Letter Offices, (4) LSG in Foreign Post Office at Mumbai, (5) LSG Accountants in Post Offices, (6) LSG Accountants in RMS Offices, (7) LSG in IPSD, (8) LSG in Circle Offices and Regional Offices, (9) LSG in SB Control Organisation.

DPC Composition:

1. Director of Postal Services – Chairman; 2. Assistant Postmaster General – Member; 3. Senior Superintendent of Post Offices – Member.

★ **NOTE:** LSG is a pure promotion post with NO direct recruitment or LDCE component. It is the FIRST promotion from PA/SA level. Qualifying service: 5 years in Level 4.

Chapter 8: Higher Selection Grade-II (HSG-II) – Group B (NG)**Gazette Notification:** G.S.R. 746(E) dated 19.11.2013**Short Title:** HSG-II, Group B Posts Recruitment Rules, 2013**Amendment:** G.S.R. 650(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC update: Level 6 substituted)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 6 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 35,400 – 1,12,400)
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Lower Selection Grade officials in Level 5 in the Pay Matrix
Qualifying Service	Six years regular service in LSG (Level 5) Note: 3 years for those holding LSG on regular basis on date of notification of RR 2013
Training Requirement	Successfully completed two weeks Departmental Training related to duties of higher post
Probation	Two years

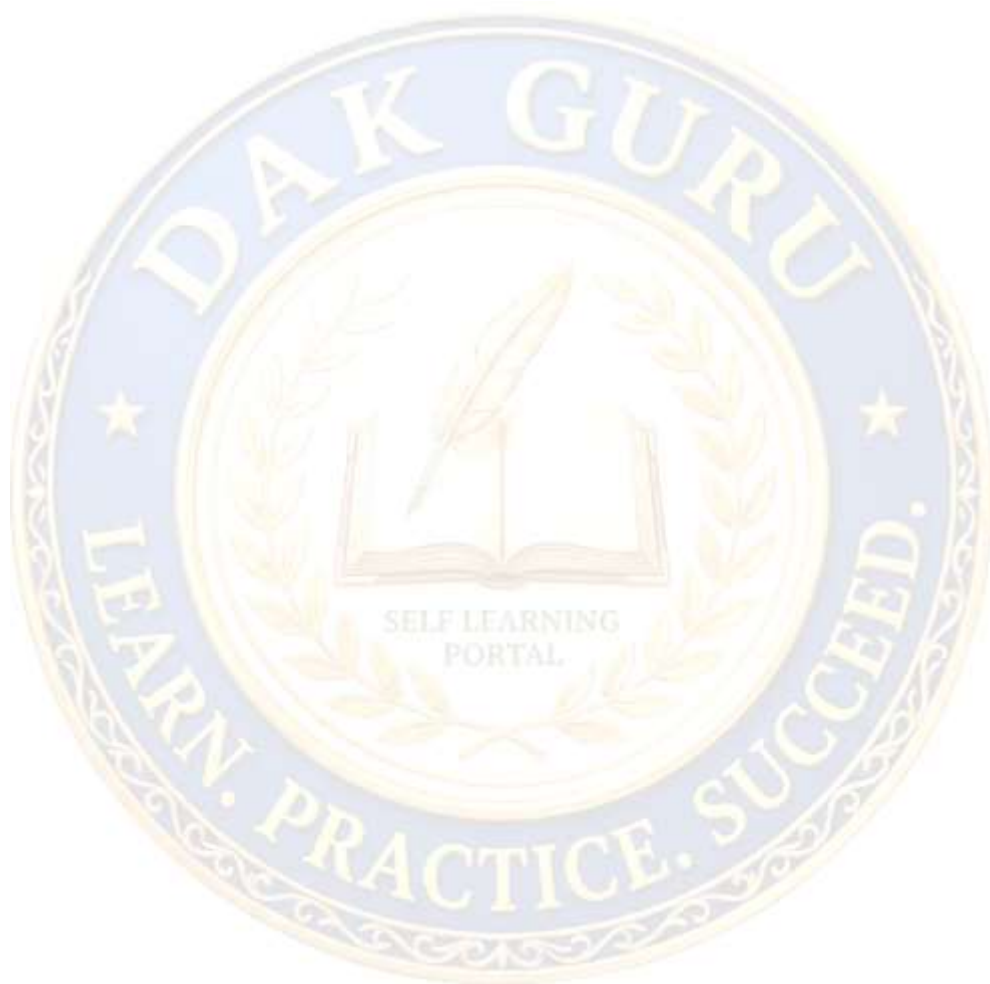
Sub-Categories:

HSG-II posts exist in: (1) Post Offices (including Foreign Post Offices other than at Mumbai), (2) RMS Offices, (3) SB Control Organisation, (4) Circle Office/Regional Offices, (5) Returned Letter Offices, (6) Foreign Posts at Mumbai, (7) Independent Postal Stores Depot.

DPC Composition (same as LSG):

1. Director Postal Services – Chairman; 2. Asst. Postmaster General – Member; 3. Sr. Superintendent of Post Offices – Member.

★ **NOTE:** HSG-II (Level 6) is an eligible feeder grade for LDCE IP. Officials in HSG-II with 8 years qualifying service (including service in LSG and PA/SA) are eligible for LDCE IP exam.



Chapter 9: Higher Selection Grade-I (HSG-I) – Group B (NG)

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 509(E) dated 17.07.2014

Short Title: HSG-I in Post Offices and RMS Offices, Group B Posts Recruitment Rules, 2014

Amendment: G.S.R. 651(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC update)

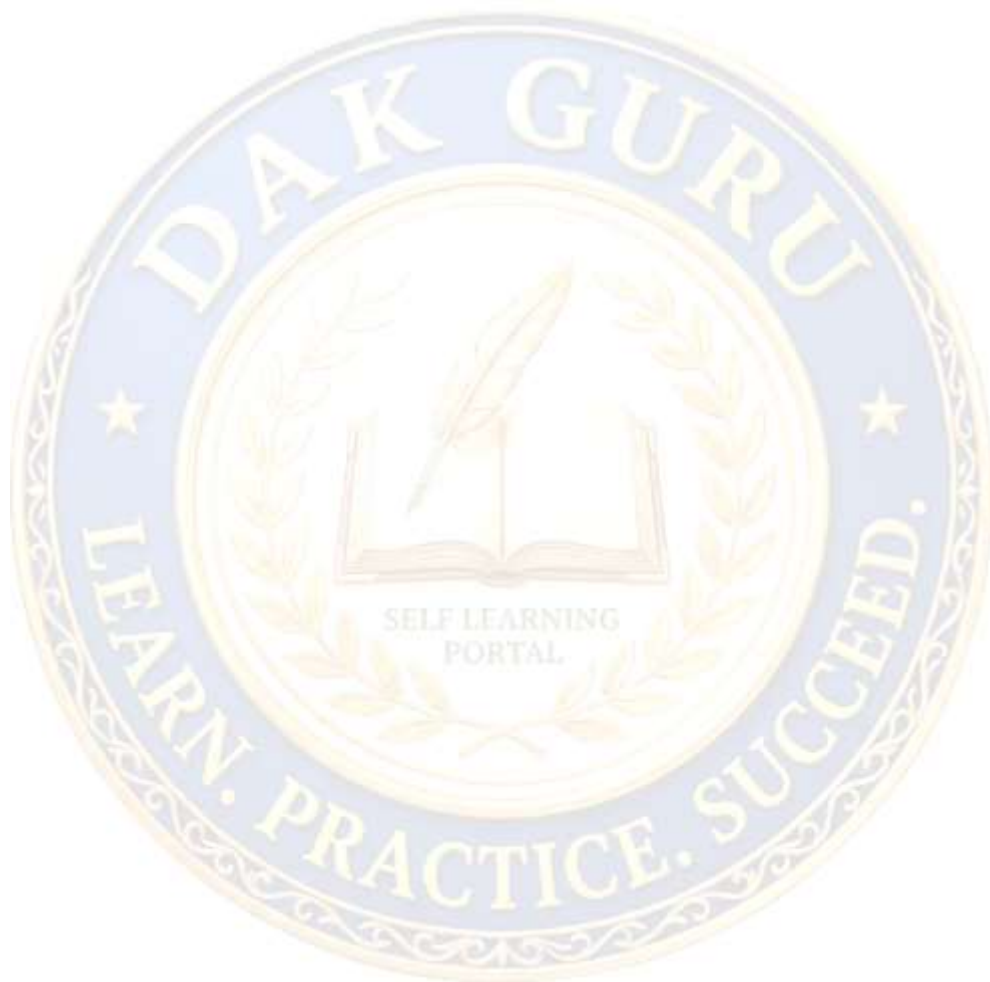
Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 7 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 44,900 – 1,42,400) [formerly PB-2 Rs. 9300–34800 + GP 4600]
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Higher Selection Grade-II officials in Level 6
Qualifying Service	Five years of regular service in HSG-II (Level 6) Note: 3 years for those holding HSG-II on regular basis on date of notification of RR 2014
Training Requirement	Successfully completed two weeks Departmental Training
Unfilled vacancies	Posts that cannot be filled due to non-availability of eligible HSG-II officers shall be operated at HSG-II level till eligible officers become available

DPC Composition:

1. Director Postal Services – Chairman; 2. Asst. Postmaster General – Member; 3. Sr. Superintendent of Post Offices – Member.

★ **NOTE:** HSG-I (Level 7) is at the same pay level as Inspector Posts. But the promotion pathway is different – HSG-I is part of the clerical line while IP is a separate cadre filled through LDCE + DR.

△ **IMPORTANT:** If HSG-I vacancies cannot be filled due to non-availability of eligible HSG-II Officials, those posts are operated at HSG-II level. This is a unique provision.



Chapter 10: Inspector of Posts (IP) – Group B (Non-Gazetted)

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 89(E) dated 05.02.2019

Short Title: Department of Posts (Inspector Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2019

Superseded: Inspector Posts RR, 2013

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 7 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 44,900 – 1,42,400)
Number of Posts	2210* (2019) *Subject to variation dependent on workload
Selection/Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Age Limit (DR)	Not exceeding 30 years (Relaxable for Govt. Servants up to 5 years)
Educational Qualification (DR)	Bachelor's Degree from a recognized University or Institute
Probation	Two years + Mandatory induction training (for both DR and Promotee officers)
Method of Recruitment	33.34% by Direct Recruitment through SSC 66.66% by Promotion through LDCE
APS Liability	Not explicitly mentioned (unlike PA/SA and Postman)

10.1 LDCE Eligibility – Feeder Grades (Column 11)

Officials of various grades with EIGHT YEARS of regular qualifying service as on the crucial date are eligible for appearing in LDCE IP:

Sl.	Feeder Grade	Pay Level	Qualifying Service Includes
(a)	Higher Selection Grade-II	Level 6	Including regular service put in as LSG and PA/SA
(b)	Postmaster Grade-II	Level 6	Including regular service put in as Postmaster Gr-I and PA
(c)	Stenographer Grade-I	Level 6	Including regular service put in as Stenographer Gr-II
(d)	Lower Selection Grade	Level 5	Including regular service put in as PA or SA
(e)	Postmaster Grade-I	Level 5	Including regular service put in as PA
(f)	Postal Assistant / Sorting Assistant	Level 4	In all offices
(g)	Stenographer Grade-II	Level 4	In all offices

△ IMPORTANT: Age limit for LDCE IP: Not exceeding 45 years as on the crucial date of eligibility to which the vacancies pertain to.

DPC / Confirmation Committee:

Group B Departmental Confirmation Committee (for considering confirmation): (1) Director of Postal Services – Chairman; (2) Asst. Postmaster General – Member; (3) Sr. Superintendent of Post Offices – Member.

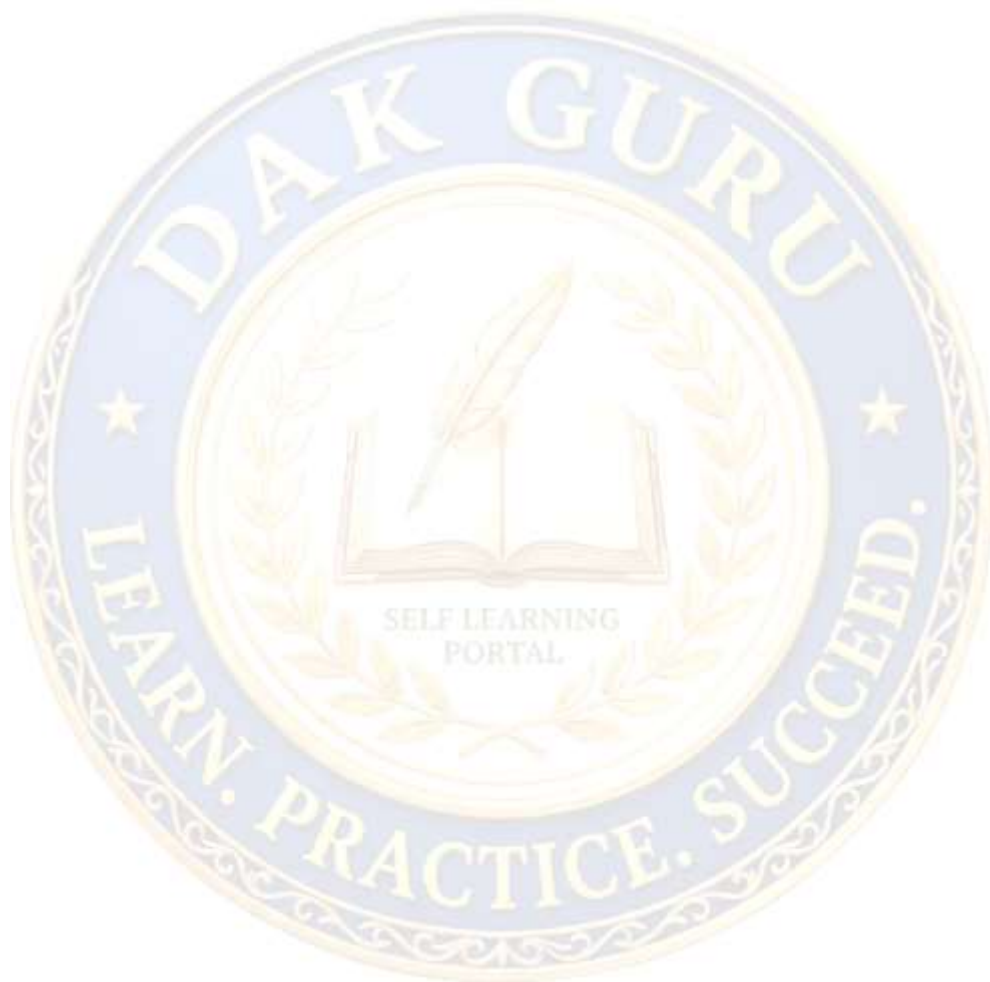
UPSC Consultation: Not necessary.

Critical Exam Points:

- The DR:LDCE ratio is 33.34% : 66.66% (approximately 1:2). This is unique in DoP.
- Eight years qualifying service is the key eligibility parameter for LDCE.
- Service in LOWER grades counts towards 8 years (e.g., PA/SA time counts for HSG-II candidate).

- 45 years is the upper age limit for LDCE IP (not 30 years, which is only for DR).
- Induction training completion is mandatory as part of probation for BOTH DR and Promotee Officers.

★ **NOTE:** The LDCE IP feeder grades list is a TOP PRIORITY memorization item. Remember the 7 feeder grades (a) to (g) and their respective qualifying service clubbing rules.



Chapter 11: Assistant Superintendent of Posts (ASP) – Group B (Gazetted)**Original Notification:** G.S.R. 61(E) dated 01.02.2013**Short Title:** Department of Posts (Assistant Superintendent of Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2013**Amendment:** G.S.R. 652(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC update – Level 8 substituted)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Gazetted
Pay Level	Level 8 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 47,600 – 1,51,100)
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Inspector of Posts in Level 7 of the Pay Matrix
Qualifying Service	Six years regular service as IP in Level 7 Amended: For those holding IP on regular basis on date of notification (2013), the eligibility service was 3 years
Training Requirement	Successfully completed two weeks Departmental Training related to duties of higher post

DPC Composition:

1. Director Postal Services – Chairman; 2. Asst. Postmaster General – Member; 3. Sr. Superintendent of Post Offices – Member.

★ **NOTE:** ASP (Level 8) is the immediate promotional grade for IP. The service rendered as ASP (Level 8) on regular basis is also counted for eligibility for promotion to PS Gr.B (as per PS Gr.B draft RR 2024).

△ **IMPORTANT:** ASP is the FIRST Gazetted post in the postal cadre hierarchy (other than Accounts Officer). IP is Non-Gazetted; ASP is Gazetted.

Chapter 12: Postal Service Group B

Original Notification: G.S.R. 379 (PS/Postmaster Group B RR, 1987)

Amendment (1993): Cadre re-designated from Postal Superintendent/Postmaster Group B to Postal Service Group B

DRAFT 2024 Draft RR for PS Gr.B circulated vide F.No.9-14/2010-SPG (Vol.II) dated 11.11.2024 for stakeholder comments

12.1 Original RR 1987 (as amended in 1993):

Method of Recruitment:

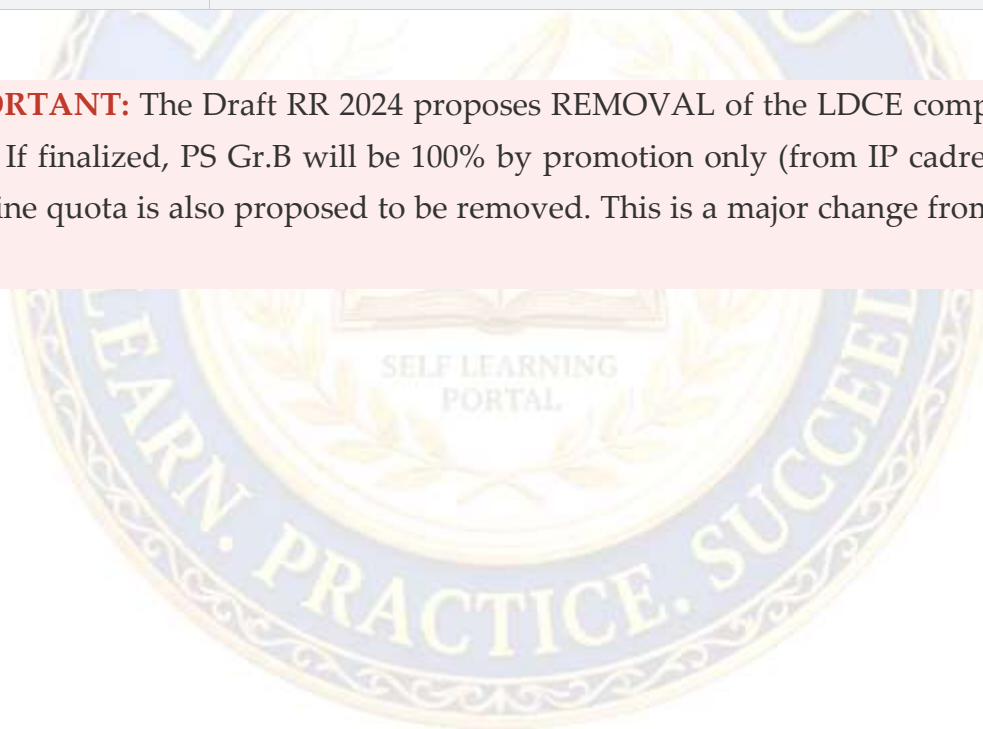
- 75% by Promotion from IPs and Inspectors of RMS (with 5 years regular service in the grade)
- 19% by Promotion through Departmental Competitive Examination from IPs and Inspectors of RMS (with 5 years regular service)
- 6% by Promotion through the same Departmental Examination from the clerical line officials working in Post Offices/Divisional Offices (with 5 years regular service in LSG and above)

12.2 Draft RR 2024 (Key Proposed Changes):

Parameter	Proposed in Draft RR 2024
Classification	General Central Service, Non-Ministerial, Gazetted, Group B
Pay Level	Level 9 in the Pay Matrix
Number of Posts	1091* (2024) *Subject to variation
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion

Parameter	Proposed in Draft RR 2024
Feeder Grade	Inspector of Posts in Level 7 with 8 years regular service in the grade + successful completion of minimum two weeks Departmental Induction Training
Service Count	Regular service rendered as ASP (Level 8) shall also be taken into account for reckoning the 8 years qualifying service
DPC Composition	1. CPMG or equivalent – Chairman 2. Director of Postal Services or equivalent – Member 3. Sr. Superintendent PO (STS level) or equivalent – Member
UPSC Consultation	Not necessary

⚠ IMPORTANT: The Draft RR 2024 proposes REMOVAL of the LDCE component for PS Gr.B. If finalized, PS Gr.B will be 100% by promotion only (from IP cadre). The 6% clerical line quota is also proposed to be removed. This is a major change from the 1987 RR.



Chapter 13: Accounts Officer & Assistant Accounts Officer – Group B

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 320(E) dated 02.04.2018

Short Title: Indian Posts and Telecommunications Accounts and Finance Service Group B (Accounts Officers and AAO) Recruitment Rules 2018

13.1 Accounts Officer (AO):

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Civil Service, Group B, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 9 (Rs. 53,100 – 1,67,800)
Selection/Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	By Promotion, failing which by Deputation
Feeder Grade	AAO in Level 8 (Rs. 47,600–1,51,100) with 2 years regular service
Training	Mandatory training in field of duties, completion within 1 year of DPC meeting
DPC	1. Advisor (Finance), Telecom Commission – Chairman 2. DDG (Estb. & Finance), DoT – Member 3. DDG (Postal Accounts & Finance) – Member

13.2 Assistant Accounts Officer (AAO):

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 8 (Rs. 47,600 – 1,51,100)
Age Limit (DR)	Not exceeding 30 years (relaxable for Govt. servants by 5 years)

Parameter	Details
Educational Qualification (DR)	Essential: Bachelor's Degree Desirable: CA / Cost & Mgt. Accountant / CS / MCom / MBA (Finance)
Probation	Two years for DR and Promotees (Group B promotees exempt) DR must qualify SAS exam or equivalent during probation
Method of Recruitment	By Promotion, failing which by Deputation, failing which by DR
Feeder (Promotion)	Departmental candidates who passed SAS exam or equivalent: • Sr./Jr. Accountants in Level 6/5 with 3/6 years service • All Group C employees with degree: Level 1 (14 yrs), Level 2 (13 yrs), Level 3 (11 yrs), Level 4 (9 yrs), Level 5 (7 yrs), Level 6 (4 yrs)
UPSC Consultation	Not necessary

★ **NOTE:** The AAO cadre has a unique multi-level qualifying service structure. Remember the Level:Years combination – Level 1 = 14 yrs, Level 2 = 13 yrs, Level 3 = 11 yrs, Level 4 = 9 yrs, Level 5 = 7 yrs, Level 6 = 4 yrs. The pattern reduces by roughly 2 years per level.

Chapter 14: Indian Postal Service (IPoS) – Group A

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 1010(E) dated 10.08.2017

Short Title: Indian Postal Service (Group A Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2017

Superseded: IPS Group A Posts RR, 2016

14.1 Grades and Pay Structure (Schedule I):

Sl.	Grade	Level	Pay Range (Rs.)	Authorized Strength
1	Apex Scale	Level 17	2,25,000 (Fixed)	1
2	Higher Administrative Grade+	Level 16	2,05,400 – 2,24,400	7
3	Higher Administrative Grade	Level 15	1,82,200 – 2,24,100	27
4	Senior Administrative Grade	Level 14	1,44,200 – 2,18,200	78
5	Junior Administrative Grade (NFSG)	Level 13	1,18,500 – 2,14,100	30% of senior duty posts
6	Junior Administrative Grade	Level 12	78,800 – 2,09,200	109
7	Senior Time Scale	Level 11	67,700 – 2,08,700	102
8	Junior Time Scale	Level 10	56,100 – 1,77,500	151
9	Reserve			86
	TOTAL			561

14.2 Method of Recruitment to Junior Time Scale (Entry Level):

- 50% by Direct Recruitment through Civil Services Examination conducted by UPSC.

- 50% by Promotion from: PS Group B in Level 9 AND Senior Postmaster Grade in Level 8, with 2 years regular service + completion of 2 weeks Departmental Induction Training.

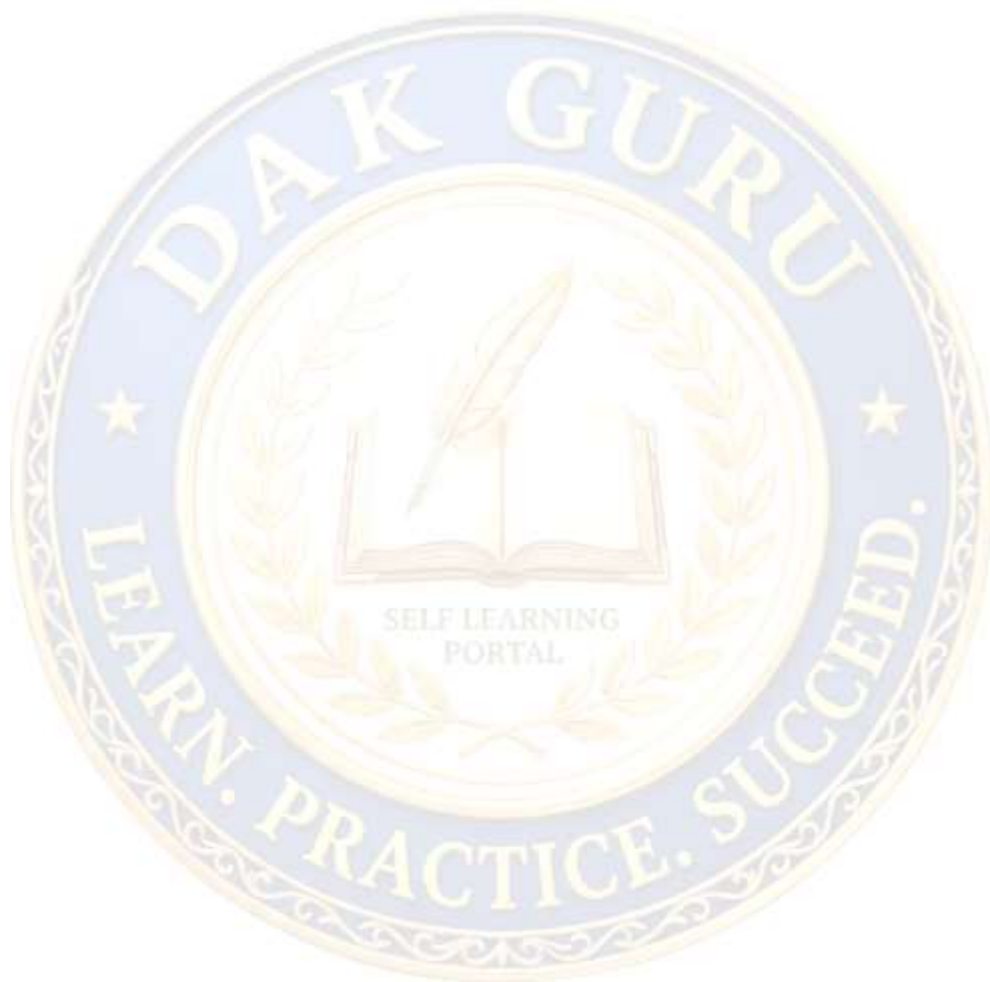
14.3 Promotion Criteria for Higher Grades (Schedule II):

From Grade	To Grade	Min. Service Required	Selection Type
JTS (Level 10)	STS (Level 11)	4 years in JTS + 2 weeks training	Selection
STS (Level 11)	JAG (Level 12)	5 years in STS + 2 weeks training	Selection
JAG (Level 12)	JAG-NFSG (Level 13)	Entered 14th year of service	Seniority subject to suitability
JAG (Level 12)	SAG (Level 14)	8 years in JAG/NFSG OR 17 years in Group A + 2 weeks training	Selection
SAG (Level 14)	HAG (Level 15)	3 years in SAG OR 25 years in Group A + 2 weeks training	Selection
HAG (Level 15)	HAG+ (Level 16)	1 year in HAG	Selection
HAG+ (Level 16)	Apex (Level 17)	1 year in HAG+	Selection

Key Features of IPoS RR 2017:

- Probation: 2 years for both DR and Promotees.
- Non-Functional Upgradation (NFU): Linked to IAS officer postings at the Centre (Schedule IV).
- Seniority: Determined by Government instructions from time to time.
- Liability: Officers are liable to serve anywhere including in Army Postal Service.
- Controlling Authority: Ministry of Communications, Department of Posts.

★ **NOTE:** The IPoS RR 2017 has FOUR Schedules: I (Grades & Strength), II (Method of Recruitment & Qualifying Service), III (DPC/DCC Composition), IV (Non-Functional Upgradation). Remember this 4-Schedule structure.



Chapter 15: Staff Car Driver Cadre – Group C

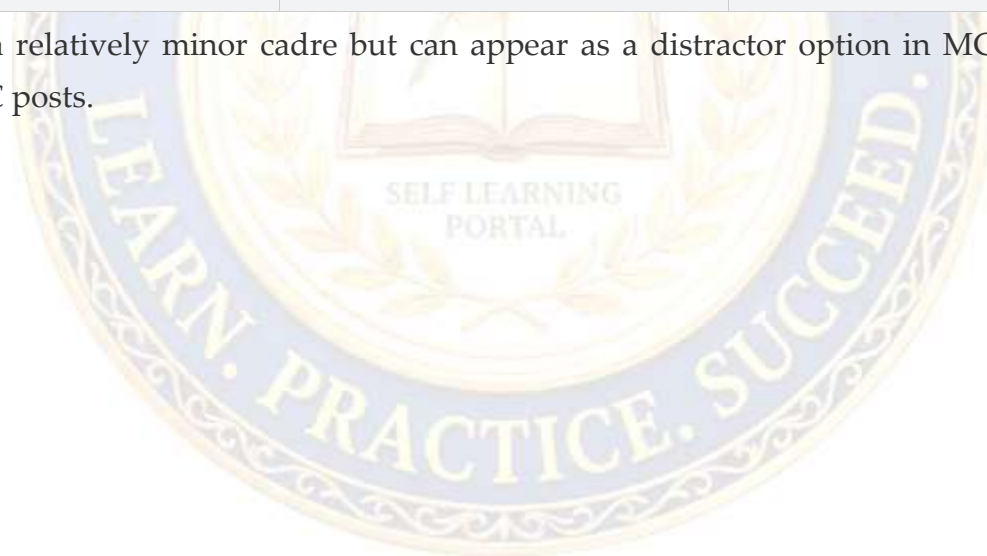
Gazette Notification: G.S.R. (2015) – Staff Car Driver (Grade-I, Grade-II, Ordinary Grade)

Short Title: Department of Posts Staff Car Driver (Grade-I), Staff Car Driver (Grade-II) and Staff Car Driver (Ordinary Grade) (Group C posts) Recruitment Rules, 2015

Amendment: G.S.R. 88(E) – Amendment Rules (7th CPC pay matrix update)

Grade	Pay Level	Method
Staff Car Driver (Ordinary Grade)	Level 2 (formerly PB-1 + GP 1900)	100% by DR or Promotion from Group D
Staff Car Driver (Grade-II)	Level 4 (formerly PB-1 + GP 2400)	By Promotion from Ordinary Grade
Staff Car Driver (Grade-I)	Level 5 (formerly PB-1 + GP 2800)	By Promotion from Grade-II

This is a relatively minor cadre but can appear as a distractor option in MCQs about Group C posts.



Chapter 16: Mail Motor Service Cadre

Gazette Notification: G.S.R. 105(E) dated 18.02.2015

Short Title: Department of Posts, Mail Motor Service, Senior Manager (NFSG), Senior Manager and Manager Recruitment Rules, 2015

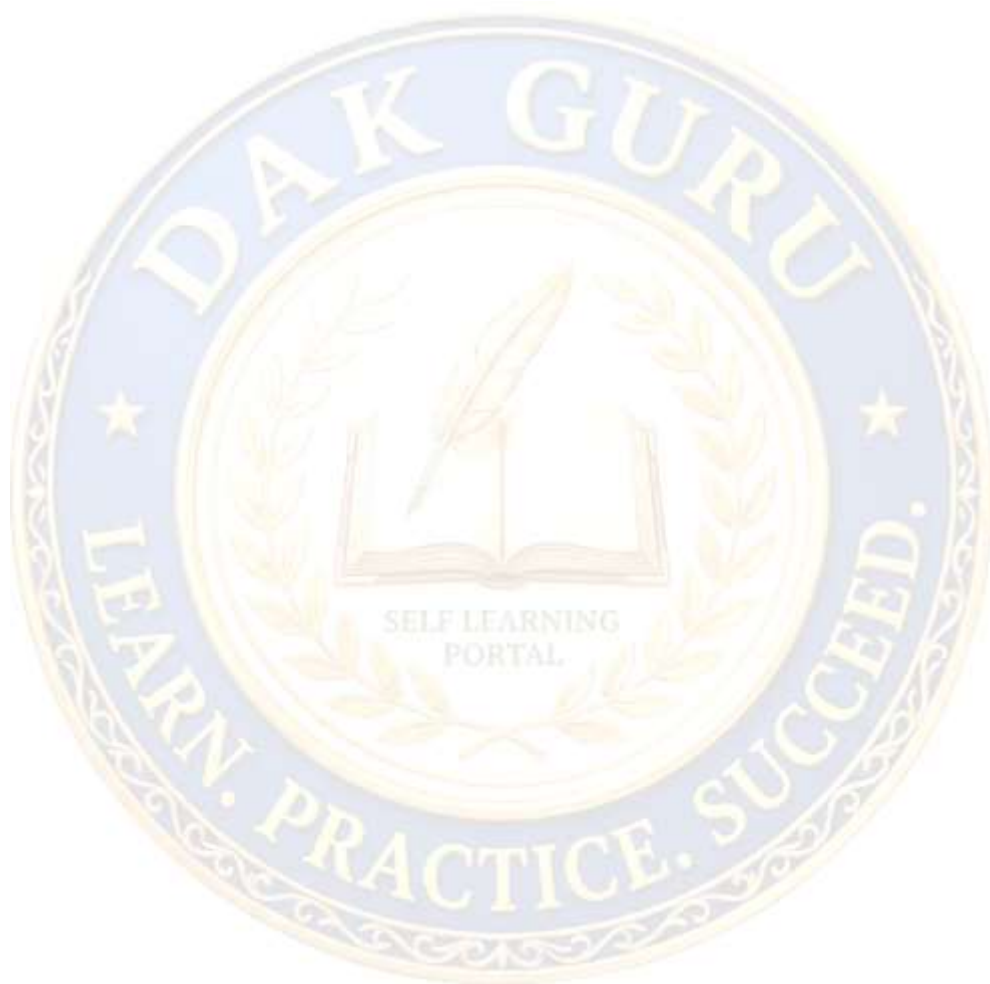
Post	Classification	Pay Level	Method
Manager, MMS	GCS Group A, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial	Level 10 (formerly PB-3 + GP 5400)	By DR or Deputation
Senior Manager, MMS	GCS Group A, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial	Level 11	By Promotion from Manager
Senior Manager (NFSG), MMS	GCS Group A, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial	Level 12	By Promotion from Senior Manager

DR Qualification for Manager: B.E./B.Tech in Mechanical or Automobile Engineering + 3 years experience in Motor Traffic operation. Age: Not exceeding 35 years.

Chapter 17: Master Comparative Table – All Cadres at a Glance

Cadre	Group	Level	Method of Recruitment	Key Qualifying Service
MTS	C (NG, NM)	Level 1	Casual Labourer / DR (100%)	N/A (entry level)
Postman/MG	C (NG, NM)	Level 3	25% SCF + 25% LDCE + 50% DR	MTS: 6 yrs (SCF) / 3 yrs (LDCE)
PA/SA	C (NG, Min)	Level 4	40% LDCE + 60% DR	Level 3: 3 yrs / Level 1-2: 5 yrs
Steno Gr-II	C (NG, Min)	Level 4	100% DR (SSC)	N/A
LSG	C (NG, Min)	Level 5	100% Promotion	PA/SA: 5 yrs in Level 4
HSG-II	B (NG, Min)	Level 6	100% Promotion	LSG: 6 yrs in Level 5
Steno Gr-I	B (NG, Min)	Level 6	100% Promotion	Steno Gr-II: prescribed service
HSG-I	B (NG, Min)	Level 7	100% Promotion	HSG-II: 5 yrs in Level 6
Inspector Posts	B (NG, Min)	Level 7	33.34% DR + 66.66% LDCE	8 yrs regular service (all feeders)
ASP	B (G)	Level 8	100% Promotion	IP: 6 yrs in Level 7
AAO	B (G, NM)	Level 8	Prom. / Dep. / DR	SAS exam + prescribed service
PS Gr.B	B (G, NM)	Level 9	100% Promotion (Draft 2024)	IP: 8 yrs in Level 7 (Draft 2024)
AO	B (G, NM)	Level 9	Promotion / Deputation	AAO: 2 yrs in Level 8
IPoS (JTS)	A (G)	Level 10	50% DR (CSE) + 50% Promotion	PS Gr.B (L-9) / Sr.PM (L-8): 2 yrs

Legend: NG = Non-Gazetted | G = Gazetted | NM = Non-Ministerial | Min = Ministerial | SCF = Seniority-cum-Fitness | DR = Direct Recruitment | LDCE = Limited Departmental Competitive Examination | CSE = Civil Services Examination



Chapter 18: Exam-Oriented Quick Revision Notes

18.1 Frequently Tested Facts

Topic	Key Point
Article 309 proviso	Constitutional basis for all Recruitment Rules
13-Point Schedule	Standard format prescribed by DoPT for all RRs
Disqualification (Bigamy)	Common clause in ALL cadre RRs
Power to Relax	In consultation with UPSC (where applicable), for reasons recorded in writing
Saving Clause	Reservation for SC/ST/OBC/Ex-Servicemen not affected
IP RR 2019	33.34% DR + 66.66% LDCE 8 years qualifying service 45 years age (LDCE)
PA/SA RR 2022	40% LDCE + 60% DR Bachelor's Degree (Graduation for GDS: 10+2)
Postman RR 2018	25% SCF + 25% LDCE + 50% DR 12th pass + Local language + Computer + Licence
MTS RR 2018	Casual Labourer first, then 100% DR 10th pass
LSG	100% Promotion PA/SA with 5 years in Level 4
HSG-II	100% Promotion LSG with 6 years in Level 5 (3 years transitional)
HSG-I	100% Promotion HSG-II with 5 years in Level 6 (3 years transitional)
ASP	100% Promotion IP with 6 years in Level 7
PS Gr.B (1987 RR)	75% Promotion + 19% Exam (IP) + 6% Exam (Clerical)
PS Gr.B (Draft 2024)	100% Promotion from IP 8 years in Level 7 ASP service counts

Topic	Key Point
IPoS JTS	50% DR (CSE by UPSC) + 50% Promotion from PS Gr.B / Sr.PM 2 years service
AAO qualifying service	Level 1=14 yrs, L2=13, L3=11, L4=9, L5=7, L6=4 years
Probation (common)	2 years for most cadres + mandatory training completion
DPC (Division level)	DPS (Chairman) + APG (Member) + Sr.SPO (Member) – for IP, ASP, LSG, HSG-I, HSG-II
UPSC consultation	NOT required for most DoP cadre promotions (explicitly stated in Column 13)

18.2 Tricky Comparison Points

Comparison	Key Difference
IP vs HSG-I	Both are Level 7, but IP is filled by LDCE+DR while HSG-I is 100% promotion from HSG-II (clerical line)
ASP vs AAO	Both are Level 8 and Gazetted Group B, but ASP is Ministerial (Postal Wing) while AAO is Non-Ministerial (Accounts Wing)
Postman vs MTS	Postman (Level 3) requires 12th pass + licence; MTS (Level 1) requires only 10th pass
PA/SA vs Postman	PA/SA is Ministerial (indoor/clerical); Postman is Non-Ministerial (outdoor/delivery)
Selection vs Non-Selection	PA/SA, LSG, HSG-I, HSG-II, AO, PS Gr.B are Selection Posts; Postman is Non-Selection; IP is 'Not Applicable'
GDS age for PA/SA vs Postman	PA/SA: 40 years; Postman: 50 years – different upper age limits
DR ratio: IP vs PA/SA	IP: 33.34% DR; PA/SA: 60% DR – IP has LESS DR and MORE LDCE

Comparison	Key Difference
Qualifying service: IP vs PS Gr.B	IP LDCE: 8 years; PS Gr.B (Draft): 8 years from IP – both require 8 years but from different feeder levels

18.3 The Complete Promotion Hierarchy

CLERICAL LINE: PA/SA (L-4) → LSG (L-5) → HSG-II (L-6) → HSG-I (L-7)

INSPECTOR LINE: PA/SA (L-4) → [LDCE] → IP (L-7) → ASP (L-8) → PS Gr.B (L-9) → IPoS JTS (L-10)

ACCOUNTS LINE: Group C → [SAS Exam] → AAO (L-8) → AO (L-9)

DELIVERY LINE: MTS (L-1) → Postman (L-3) → [LDCE to PA/SA] → then joins Clerical/Inspector Line

